

PROFILE

Cloud & Systems Engineer and Canadian citizen with 5 years building and running secure cloud and Linux infrastructure: Terraform and Azure DevOps, Kubernetes on AKS, Azure landing zones, identity and access management, and self-hosted services behind single sign-on. Current work is a production RAG system over Arabic documents and a security layer for AI agents that approves or blocks every tool call before it runs and records the decision. Previously migrated 15+ .NET applications to Azure at a Microsoft partner in Doha.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Networking: Microsoft Azure (primary), Azure landing zones, hub-and-spoke VNets, NSGs, Azure Firewall, Bastion, Private Endpoints, Managed Identity, AWS
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, ARM templates, Ansible
Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes (AKS), Helm
CI/CD: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins
Security & IAM: SSO / SAML, Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Key Vault, RBAC, Conditional Access, Authelia, LLDAP, UFW, Fail2ban
Linux & Self-Hosting: Linux, Caddy, Cloudflare, Tailscale, automated backups
Observability: OpenTelemetry, Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, Splunk, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics
AI / RAG: RAG pipelines including multilingual, vector search, embeddings & rerankers, Qdrant, ChromaDB, LLM deployment (vLLM, Ollama), LangChain, LoRA / QLoRA fine-tuning
AI Security: Agentic AI security, OWASP MCP Top 10, Cisco AI Defense, DefenseClaw, Agent Control, Galileo, prompt-injection defense, MCP
Languages: Python (Flask), PowerShell, Bash, HCL, SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cloud & Infrastructure Engineer *ZIACO Industries Limited*

Nov 2024 – Present
Remote

- Built and run a 13-service containerized private cloud on a dedicated Linux server (ERP, custom Flask finance apps, video conferencing, SSO via Caddy + Authelia + LLDAP, automated backups with Telegram alerting) as the sole infrastructure engineer, with network segmentation, default-deny access control, UFW/Fail2ban and automated intrusion detection across a 3-country encrypted mesh network.
- Built a custom Flask application integrated with an ERP API for daily ledger entries, receipt capture, and multi-currency reconciliation, replacing commercial SaaS with a self-hosted alternative.
- Set up a shared GPU workstation as a jump server for a 5-engineer team: SSH gated by Tailscale identity instead of managed key files, demos published via Cloudflare Tunnel with Google SSO and an email allowlist, per-user browser IDEs, and one admin CLI so onboarding is a single command.
- Built a production RAG system over Arabic-first policy documents (95% Arabic) on Qdrant with locally served models, designed to answer only from retrieved sources and refuse rather than guess, with verification passes over answers.
- Built the security layer for AI agents: every tool call is approved or blocked before it runs, and blocked outright if the checker is unreachable; decisions record to Splunk and model turns score in Galileo, using Cisco AI Defense inline inspection and Agent Control policy.
- Compared LoRA and QLoRA fine-tuning and showed the memory-saving method cost 51% more time for a saving the hardware did not need; found a bug in NVIDIA's NeMo container that writes adapter files under key names the loader silently ignores.

Cloud Engineer *Mannai Microsoft Solutions*

Jun 2023 – Sep 2024
Doha, Qatar

- Led the migration of 15+ .NET enterprise applications to Azure App Service and AKS, with production/staging/test environments and CI/CD via Azure DevOps and Terraform.
- Replaced manual multi-step releases with Terraform-driven CI/CD pipelines, so a deployment became a single pipeline run with the same result in every environment.
- Built an Azure landing zone in Terraform for a government health client: hub-and-spoke VNets and NSG rules generated from a source spreadsheet, Azure Firewall, Bastion for admin access, Key Vault for secrets, and Log Analytics collecting from every spoke.
- Built a RAG pipeline for enterprise clients using Python, ChromaDB, and LangChain, automating document ingestion, embedding, and deployment.

Tech Supervisor & Professor's Assistant
Global Studies Institute (USC / Arkansas State)

Sep 2021 – Jun 2023
Doha, Qatar

- Managed accounts, access, and security policies across Active Directory and Azure AD for 200+ students and faculty.
- Cut repeat classroom and lab failures by monitoring for the underlying faults and fixing causes rather than resetting machines.
- Managed locally hosted Windows/Linux servers plus Azure cloud services.

Cloud DevOps Intern
Snoonu Co.

Apr 2022 – Jul 2022
Doha, Qatar

- Configured Jenkins CI/CD pipelines with automated QA via Cypress and built SQL-based service-health dashboards.
- Deployed multi-container applications on AKS using Helm across dev, staging, and production.
- Introduced a branching and review convention that cut repeat merge conflicts, and mentored teammates on DevOps workflows.

Sales & Operations
Alif Stores / Alamat Trading

Jan 2020 – Sep 2021
Doha, Qatar

- Built a barcode-scanner-integrated inventory system using Microsoft PowerApps, reducing stock-count time by **53%** and enabling real-time tracking.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Open-source · github.com/siddiqitaha

MCP Attack Lab — Five MCP servers, each broken on purpose in a different way: tool poisoning, indirect prompt injection, rug pull, data exfiltration, privilege abuse. Five of the ten weaknesses in the OWASP MCP Top 10. Run a scanner against them and you find out which ones a scan can catch and which only show up at runtime. *Python, MCP SDK*.

Galileo-Governed OpenClaw — An AI agent that can run real commands, with a check in front of every one. The call is approved or blocked before it runs, and blocked if the checker cannot be reached. Decisions go to Splunk, model turns go to Galileo. Starts with one docker compose up. *Agent Control, Galileo, Splunk, Docker*.

The AI Body — A local AI agent built as five parts you can swap out, with one core that makes the decisions. If a part fails or is not trusted, the system stops instead of carrying on, so a new component can be tried without being trusted first. *Python, Docker*.

Azure Terraform Platform — Terraform modules for an AKS platform: VNet, AKS, container registry, Key Vault, Log Analytics. One terraform apply builds all of it. Dev and prod share the same code but keep separate state and variables, and every pull request runs fmt, validate and plan before anything merges. *Terraform, Azure, GitHub Actions*.

Self-Hosted Private Cloud — Several services behind one reverse proxy, with single sign-on and 2FA in front of all of them. Nothing is reachable unless it is explicitly allowed, the services talk to each other on an internal network only, and volume backups run on a schedule and alert if one fails. *Docker Compose, Caddy, Authelia, LDAP*.

EDUCATION

University of Aberdeen
BSc Business Management & Information Systems

Doha, Qatar
Sep 2020 – Jun 2024

- **Campus Committee Chairman:** led a 19-member committee, organized career fairs, co-authored student bylaws (Leadership Academy, 2021).

Elev8 Future Digital Leaders — Microsoft Qatar
Cloud Solution Architecture Program

Doha, Qatar
2022

CERTIFICATIONS

Exam AZ-303: Microsoft Azure Architect Technologies · Microsoft (passed Feb 2021)

KCNA: Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate · Linux Foundation (Oct 2023, expires Oct 2026)

AZ-900: Microsoft Azure Fundamentals · Microsoft (Aug 2020)

Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning · Samsung Innovation Campus (2023-2024, capstone 1st place)

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

FIFA World Cup 2022 (Coca-Cola Fanzone), Staff Manager, Doha 2022 — led 25+ staff across multiple venues.

Qatar Red Crescent Covid-19 Response, Emergency Response Coordinator, Doha 2020–2021 — supervised 15 volunteers serving 9,000 patients.